POWERPLAY — Quick Reference

Players: 3–5 | **Hand:** 3 Action + 2 Reaction (refilled free each round) | **Starting Power:** 0 for every character | **Game:** 4 rounds, 8 turns per player

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Exchange Rates

3 Coins = 1 Influence | 2 Influence = 1 Power *(forward only; at Call-it-a-Night)*

Playing Cards — Activation Ladder (Action + Reaction)

Action and Reaction cards are **free to play** — no Coin cost, no Power Floor on cards.

- **Action (Base, free):** base effect resolves + **2 of your primary-Industry Assets fire** their Synergy clauses.
- **Influencing Decision (optional, pay 1 Influence):** the card's secondary Industry is unlocked and **1 more Asset fires** (from either Industry) — **3 fires total**. No other levels; no Coin activation costs.
- **Reaction:** on play, **1 matching-Industry Asset fires** automatically.

Fires resolve one at a time, in the order the acting player chooses; each targeted player may React before their fire resolves. Asset Use Floors (T1 0 P / T2 2 P / T3 3 P) gate which Assets may fire — Power is **checked, not spent**.

Asset Tiers

Tier	Cost	Buy Floor	Use Floor	Op Cost	Signing Bonus
T1	4 C	0 P	0 P	0	none
T2	8 C	2 P	2 P	1 C	Gain 1 IP
T3	14 C	3 P	3 P	2 C	Gain 1 Power

Round Structure (7 phases — turn order from Leader)

1. **Morning News** — Draw + read aloud 1 Event (the Morning event); resolve (one-shot ends now / ongoing lasts **until the next Morning News**). Every Event carries an **Event Objective** (condition + reward = **1 Power**, claimed in the moment, open to all, once per player per event).
2. **Opening Bell (batch upkeep)** — **Draw Hands** (discard, then free refill to 3 Action + 2 Reaction); **Income Roll** (one die per Asset tier owned — T1 D4 / T2 D6 / T3 D10; die face = Coins per Asset; minus Op Costs; Income Reroll 2 C). *Card buying is NOT here — it happens at The Inbox, the start of each player's turn.*
3. **Market Operation** — Sealed-Bid Draft: opt in, pull 1 Asset per participant to a shared row (T2 needs 2 P + 4 C; T3 needs 3 P + 7 C), secret Coin bids revealed at once, highest-first picks (pay your bid, min ½ cost); 1-Coin bidders go all-in, last, for leftovers.
4. **Market Manipulation — Phase 1** — first player turns (The Inbox → Action → Organize the Desk).
5. **Lunch Break (mid-round economy)** — five sub-phases, each in turn order from the Leader: **(1) Afternoon News** (draw + read aloud a 2nd Event; active until the next Afternoon News → overlaps into the next round's first half; two Events now active). **(2) Loans** — borrow against an unmortgaged Asset for ½ printed cost. **(3) Trading Window** — trade Cards (Action / Reaction) + Assets + Coins + IOUs (IP & P not tradable); **2 deals max per player per window**; a creditor may resell an IOU to a 3rd party. **(4) Private Equity** — fee (1 / 2 / 3 C) + draw 2, buy 1 at printed cost. **(5) Sells** — sell an unmortgaged Asset at printed cost (mortgaged Assets cannot be sold).
6. **Market Manipulation — Phase 2** — second player turns.
7. **Call-it-a-Night** — Settle own books: Currency Conversion → Debt Settlement (loans **from supply**, IOUs **player-to-player**) → Thievery (lowest Power assigns the Leader).

Turn Structure (lean — upkeep at Opening Bell, economy at Lunch Break)

1. **The Inbox** — optionally buy up to **1 Action card (2 C)** and up to **1 Reaction card (1 C)**; for each, draw the top 2 of that deck, keep 1, discard the other.
2. **Action** — Exactly **1 Standard Action**: Play an Action card (free; the only Standard Action; may be left unused) — base effect + 2 primary-Industry Asset fires, or 3 fires with the 1-Influence Influencing Decision. **Free Actions** (don't consume the action): Character Ability (free; once per round; requires holding 2 Power, checked not spent; usable only in the phase printed on the character card), PowerPlay! (1 P → play up to 2 Action cards this turn, one gets the Influencing Decision free + draw 1 Action + 1 Reaction + declare up to 2 Synergy fires Sacred; Sacred, once per turn).
3. **Organize the Desk** — Attach cleanup; a **Freeze is an attachment** removed here (that's how an Asset unfreezes). No per-turn discard — hand resets at next Opening Bell.

Reactions

Played out of turn, **only in response to** an Action card, an individual Asset Synergy fire, or an Event — never proactively on your own turn. **Any Reaction can Counter any Action or any single fire** (no tier restrictions). Reactions **mitigate** — they reduce or compensate, they do not fully negate. **No Reaction-to-Reaction**: a Reaction can never be played in response to another Reaction — the chain ends at the first Reaction. On play, 1 of the Reactor's matching-Industry Assets fires automatically. **Sacred plays open no response window at all.**

IOU (Defender Debt — player-to-player)

If an Action demands a resource the Defender lacks, they take a Coin IOU **owed to the Attacker** instead: insufficient IP → 4 C; insufficient Power → 7 C; insufficient Coin → (X+1) C. Max 2 new IOUs / Defender / round. Settled at Call-it-a-Night Debt Settlement; unpaid → forced Asset liquidation (bank pays Asset cost, Defender pays Attacker); elimination only if no unencumbered Assets remain. Tradable in the Lunch Break Trading Window. *Loans, by contrast, are player ↔ supply — see the Manual § II.*

Income Dice (Opening Bell)

Roll **one die per Asset tier you own**; the **die face is the Coins paid per Asset** of that tier (Frozen Assets still earn income — a freeze only locks the Synergy), minus Operating Costs.

Tier	Income Die	Op Cost / Asset
T1	D4	0
T2	D6	1 C
T3	D10	2 C

Income Reroll: pay 2 C to reroll any one income die (available to every player).

Game Length

- **4 rounds** (one per fiscal quarter — a full fiscal year); **8 turns per player** (2 per round)

End Game

Clean the Books (after the final Call-it-a-Night): settle every outstanding loan (pay principal + 1 C, or default → Asset → discard, bank pays cost, surplus to you). No elimination from loan default.

Scoring: `Total Power = Power + floor(IP/2) + floor(C/6) + floor(AssetValue/5)` — Coins score at /6 and Asset Value at /5, so Assets reward more than raw Coin hoarding.

Tie-breaker: Best-of-3 Rock, Paper, Scissors, Lizard, Spock.

